

Finally, Vista has updated old programs such as Internet Explorer to bring them on par with modern Web browsers, while it also introduces new software such as Windows Meeting Space, which leverage peer-to-peer and ad-hoc networking to communicate and interface with friends and colleagues. Let's take a look at each of these features—from those that help us connect to a network, to those that help us troubleshoot a network connection.

8.1 A Central Networking Interface

Much like the central Security panel that Vista offers, the operating system also presents a central location from which to manage your various network resources. This management is done through the Network and Sharing Center, and can be accessed by going to **Start > Control Panel > Network and Internet > Network Sharing Center**.

The Network Sharing Center offers two aspects to your network: a status view on all your network connections is displayed to the right-hand side of the Center; the left-hand pane, meanwhile, offers links to common networking tasks.



Getting to the Network options



The Network options

The first item of notice is that the Network and Sharing Center displays a rudimentary map of how your computer is connected to